Joshua Choper

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EMPLOYMENT

University College London, Social Research Institute
2025- Postdoctoral Research Fellow
Principal Investigator: Per Engzell

Bocconi University, Dondena Centre for Research on Social Dynamics
2024-2025 Postdoctoral Research Fellow
Principal Investigator: Zachary Parolin

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley
2020-2024 Ph.D., Sociology
Dissertation: *Intragenerational Mobility and Inequality in Local Labor Markets*
Committee: Neil Fligstein (chair), Heather Haveman, David Card (Economics), Daniel Schneider (Harvard Kennedy School of Government)
2019 MA, Sociology
Qualifying exams: Stratification and Inequality, Organizations, Theory
2017-2018 NICHD Trainee in Demography

University of Chicago
2017 MPP, Harris School of Public Policy
2016 BA, Professional Option: Public Policy
Honors: Phi Beta Kappa (junior year), Student Marshal, General Honors

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Stratification and Inequality, Mobility, Labor Markets, Work, Organizations, Economic Sociology, Education, Causal Inference, Quantitative Methods

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Forth. **Joshua Choper.** "Black-White Inequality in Earnings Losses After Job Displacement, 1981-2020." *Social Forces*. https://doi.org/10.1093/sf/soaf212

2026 **Joshua Choper**, Lukas Lehner, and Zachary Parolin. "Countervailing Powers: Labor Unions Against the Buyer Power of Walmart Supercenters." *American Sociological Review* 91(3): 435-463. https://doi.org/10.1177/00031224261437057

2026 **Joshua Choper.** "Managing Motherhood: How 'Queen Bee' Managers in the US Service Sector Reduce Motherhood Advantages in Work Scheduling." *Social Forces* 104(4): 1258-1285. https://doi.org/10.1093/sf/soaf193

2022 **Joshua Choper**, Daniel Schneider, and Kristen Harknett. "Uncertain Time: Precarious Schedules and Job Turnover in the U.S. Service Sector." *ILR Review* 75(5): 1099-132. https://doi.org/10.1177/00197939211048484

UNDER REVIEW/IN PREPARATION

Joshua Choper. "Stratification After Job Displacement: Shifting Job Tasks and Inequalities in Post-Displacement Earnings" (Conditionally Accepted, *Socio-Economic Review*)

Joshua Choper, Per Engzell, and Nathan Wilmers. "Inherited Professional Contacts and Intergenerational Persistence" (In preparation)

Joshua Choper, Lukas Lehner, and Zachary Parolin. "The Limits of Labor Power: How Employer Buyer Power Moderates the Union Wage Premium" (In preparation for invited contribution to special issue of *British Journal of Industrial Relations*)

Joshua Choper. "The Career Mobility Dynamics of Job Quality in the US Service Sector" (In preparation)

Joshua Choper and Zachary Parolin. "Inequality and the Making of the Platform Economy" (In preparation)

Joshua Choper. "Local Labor Market Polarization and Inequality in Career Earnings Mobility." (In preparation)

Joshua Choper. "When the Metric Moves the Margin: Test-Based Teacher Evaluation and the Classification of Students into Special Education." (In preparation)

OTHER WRITING

2022 **Joshua Choper**, Daniel Schneider, and Kristen Harknett. "Work schedule instability increases turnover among low-wage workers, leading to lost earnings and horizontal mobility." *Work in Progress*.

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Aage Sørensen Award, International Sociological Association Research Committee on Stratification and Mobility (RC28) (2024)
Doctoral Completion Fellowship, UC Berkeley (2023-2024)
Lowenthal Fellowship, UC Berkeley Department of Sociology (2021-2022)
Institute for Research on Labor and Employment Faculty Research Award (with Neil Fligstein), UC Berkeley (2021)
Summer Research Grant, UC Berkeley Department of Sociology (2021)
Small Research Grant, UC Berkeley Department of Sociology (2021)
Institute for Research on Labor and Employment Student Research Award, UC Berkeley (2019)
Small Research Grant, UC Berkeley Department of Sociology (2019)
David and Aileen Wang Family Fellowship, UC Berkeley (2018-2019)
NICHD Training Grant in Demography (2017-2018)
Dean's Scholarship, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy (2015-2017)
Student Marshal, University of Chicago (2015)
Phi Beta Kappa, University of Chicago (2015)

PRESENTATIONS

Invited talks: Nuffield College at the University of Oxford Sociology Seminar Series (Oxford, November 2026)

Conferences: (2026) Atkinson Conference on Economic and Social Inequality (Oxford, September); American Sociological Association (New York, August); RC28 Social Stratification (New York, August); COIN Annual Workshop (Paris, June); European Consortium for Sociological Research (Dublin, June); RC28 Social Stratification (Seville, May); QSS-CLS-CNET Joint Seminar (London, UK); (2025) London School of Economics International Inequalities Institute 10th Anniversary Conference (London, September); RC28 Social Stratification (Milan, March); (2024) American Sociological Association (Montreal, August); RC28 Social Stratification (Providence, August); (2023) American Sociological Association (Philadelphia, August); Population Association of America (New Orleans, April); (2019) American Sociological Association (New York, August); Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (Barcelona, July)

TEACHING AND MENTORING

Awards

Outstanding GSI Award (university-wide), University of California, Berkeley 2020-2021

Postgraduate teaching

Advanced Social Data Science (MSc), University College London 2026
Co-lead instructor

Methods of Sociological Research (PhD), University of California, Berkeley 2020-2021
Graduate student instructor

Undergraduate teaching

Evaluation of Evidence, University of California, Berkeley 2020
Graduate student instructor

Politics and Policy, University of Chicago 2016
Teaching assistant

Supervision

MA/MSc dissertations: 2 ongoing

Mentorship

BA theses: 2 completed

Undergraduate research assistantships: 1 completed

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Occasional reviewer: *American Sociological Review; Social Forces; Research in Social Stratification and Mobility; ILR Review; Work and Occupations; Social Currents; The Sociological Quarterly; Community, Work, and Family; Advances in Life Course Research*

REFERENCES

Neil Fligstein
Class of 1939 Chancellor's Professor
Department of Sociology
University of California, Berkeley
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Heather Haveman
Professor of Sociology
Professor of Business
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Daniel Schneider

Zachary Parolin

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